

[Skip to main content](#)[r/GooglePixel](#) ×

Search in r/GooglePixel



Create

**r/GooglePixel** • 5mo ago
SweatyAdagio4

...

WARNING: Google Repair Illegally Reports Damage to Devices to Avoid Liability

TLDR: Google's repair centers report false damages to devices to avoid being liable for repairs.

I've had a Pixel 8 since November 2023, suddenly started getting the infamous vertical line through the screen a couple of weeks back, occasionally. Google told me I could get it repaired free of charge, since it is a manufacturing defect. I recorded the issue, recorded me packing it, and upon arrival in Poland, I got a report back saying they 1) couldn't locate the issue and 2) other damage was found to the front or the frame of the device, and thus giving me two options to either send it back unrepaired or pay 125 euro to just fix the external damages they reported.

I always use my device with a case, a screen protector from ZAGG and a usb-c port plug to avoid any dust getting in. I clean my phone with a special phone cleaning brush once every couple of weeks. My phone basically looked brand new when I sent it.

I sent them the video of the problem and me packing the naked Pixel 8 (with no external damage) to Google support, and they told me they were going to escalate it. Lo and behold, after 1.5 weeks of waiting they came back to me with their evaluation:

As per our higher department's assessment, the photo you provided shows damage that falls under the non-warranty category based on Google's criteria. Specifically, the issue has been identified as bottom speaker mesh damage.

They sent back my phone unrepaired, and upon receiving it back, it's still exactly as it is when I sent it. There is no visible damage to the device, it looks brand new. Yet Google persists that there is damage to my device.

I live in the EU. Even if there was the damage they claimed there was, speaker mesh damage is unrelated to the screen issue that I provided evidence of in the video, meaning they would still have to repair it free of charge. Especially considering there is no such damage to my device, according to Dutch law (Burgerlijk Wetboek 7:17 and 7:21) and EU Directive 2019/771, Google cannot lawfully refuse warranty repair on the basis of non-existent damage. Yet they straight up looked at my videos and said "We see speaker mesh damage in your photo so we won't repair it".

During my repair process, I quickly lost hope of getting it resolved through Google as I looked through other posts reporting eerily similar situations:

- https://old.reddit.com/r/Pixel8phones/comments/1n0j4t3/flickering_green_screen_repair_scam/ - Very similar situation as mine, Pixel 8 screen issue, took video/photo evidence before sending, repair center reports not being able to find the issue and claims other physical damage.
- https://old.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1mika3g/unfair_pixel_6a_repair_charges_in_india_under/ - Granted, this is a user from India, not EU: Pixel 6a battery replacement, under warranty, Google claims a display issue and they can only fix both or nothing. User pays and battery issues remains.
- https://old.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1lwzcyn/pixel_9_repair_scam/ - Pixel 9 user in the UK also started having the screen issue (thought it was only a Pixel 8 thing, but apparently not). User also had a defective front camera, but repair center claims on top of that there's physical damage, also to the outside frame. Google refuses to repair unless all 3 (camera, physical damage and screen) are paid for.
- https://old.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1lsibk2/google_rma_tries_to_scam_me_650_euros_for_a_n_on/ - Pixel Fold fingerprint reader defect, Google claims reported issue can't be found but reporting that

Skip to main content



Create



[https://www.reddit.com/r/pixel_phones/comments/1n918ro/pixel_8_vertical_lines_warranty_problem/](#) - Pixel Fold 2 user in Australia with lots of issues: Screens suddenly not working, getting stuck on bootup, battery indicator showing no state when unfolded. User did damage the outer glass of camera. Google refuses to repair the device

- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1lydxr/google_pixel_8_support_are_they_trying_to_scam_me/ - Pixel 8 user also got the pink vertical line, sends it, Google claims additional damage, escalates it, Google reports bottom speaker mesh damage and refuses to repair. Eventually the user somehow convinces Google to reimburse the repair. This user also managed to convince Google to send photos with "evidence" of speaker mesh damage.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1h5ee5x/pixel_8_repair_scam_be_warned/ - Pixel 8 vertical line issue, Google repair center claims "outside frame or back cover damage" yet again.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/pixel_phones/comments/1hni3mf/pixel_8_screen_repair_scam/ - Pixel 8 vertical line + flickering screen. Repair center claims broken back plate, broken front camera, broken phone calls (all false according to user).
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1hbmamq/sent_pixel_8_for_screen_rma_google_changed_my/ - Pixel 8 flickering screen, Google claims external damage (back cover damage), provided evidence but Google sticks to claim that there's damage.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/pixel_phones/comments/1h6jqfi/google_pixel_they_will_use_any_excuse_to_avoid/ - Pixel 8 vertical line issue, waited for lines to be permanent, Google reports screen is cracked but user provided photos with no cracked screen. User resorts to getting it repaired to a local store on their own dime.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1mh5p2f/mailed_in_my_pixel_7a_for_battery_replacement_now/ - Pixel 7a battery issue, Google charges for cosmetic damage, refuses to do partial repairs.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/p49ayh/beware_of_googles_warranty_scam/ - Pixel 5 unspecified software issue, Google claims to be able to repair it but then reports physical damage.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1mtzfh3/google_warranty_issues/ - Pixel 7a battery issue in warranty, but battery caused glass to crack which Google claims is out of warranty.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1i4a2l2/sent_pixel_for_free_battery_replacement_now/ - Very little info, but user reports battery issue with Pixel 4a, within warranty, Google repair charges them for unexpected damage.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1lhvl0w/warning_about_google_pixel_repair_support/ - Pixel 8 vertical line, Google replaces it with a refurbished device, year later it happens again, Google refuses to replace the device a second time.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1ctc469/google_warranty_for_pixel8_is_a_scam/ - Pixel 8 black spot on screen. Google claims device is not eligible for warranty even though it's a common Pixel 8 issue.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1e6kkhm/google_pixel_support_nightmare_promised_free/ - Pixel Fold not switching between inner and outer screens, user reports some minor cosmetic damage (scratches). Upon sending, Google drops 698 dollar fee for repair or it will be sent back unrepared.
- https://old.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1n918ro/pixel_8_vertical_lines_warranty_problem/ - Pixel 8 screen flickering and green line, user sent it to repair center in Poland which reported damage to frame or back which wasn't there when user sent the device, refuses to repair display unless customer pays 135 euro for non-existent physical damage to the device.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1n8586o/worst_customer_service_experience_ever/ - Pixel 8 Pro with bluetooth issues, customer support said it could be repaired, phone sent but then repair

[Skip to main content](#)

Create



[https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1nce351/warning_google_repair_illegally_reports_damage_to_devices_to_avoid_liability/](#) - I made a report about my phone suddenly died, no physical damage. Google says its not covered and wants 547 Euro.

- <https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/s/TMtyxsOgP6> - Similar issue to others. Pixel 8 won't turn on, sends for repair, repair center claims device has damage to the outside. Only after pressing them for more info do they claim "speaker mesh damage" as a reason to not honour the warranty.
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1n1p37x/google_repair_center_being_dishonest/ - My post

This is just a handful of posts I found doing a quick search on reddit. This is a systemic problem in Google repair. Their repair partners report false damage, Google support stands behind their claims in most cases regardless of evidence to the contrary. I count 9x Pixel 8 issues excluding my own experience, all with very similar experiences to mine. Only one user reports a successful resolution being able to convince Google to cover the damage.

I made a report to the Dutch ACM but not sure if they will do anything with. I will try to get mine repaired through the retailer I got it from originally, but already have been without a phone for two weeks due to this exhausting back and forth with Google.

EDIT: So the retailer, Belsimpel (Gomibo in Belgium) stand by the repair shops conclusion and are claiming that due to the speaker mesh damage, the phone is not water or dust resistant anymore, it loses its IP68 rating. However, the extended warranty page clearly states that they can only deny warranty if there are signs of water intrusion or a cracked screen for instance. They just provided really blurry photos of the speaker mesh damage. When I point out that's no evidence of liquid intrusion, they ignore me. Avoid Belsimpel, Gomibo, and Google Pixel phones, as they're illegally denying valid warranty claims on factory issues.

Also, please feel free to leave a bad review at the scammy Polish repair center on Google Maps if you've experienced similar issues: <https://maps.app.goo.gl/Py1VocfsDQx35QqH8>



401

160

Share

[Join the conversation](#)Sort by: **Best** ▾

Search Comments

**zarco92** • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

Very similar to what Asus tried to pull in that Gamersnexus' video where they sent an Rog Ally for repairs (it was the joystick iirc). They replied with a picture of a minuscule nick on the shell and tried to charge them for that instead, which wasn't even related to the issue they RMA'd it for. There was quite a bit of backlash there.

**lululock** • 5mo ago

Maybe they should investigate Google's RMA shenanigans. I know it's not gaming related but it's about customer rights !



[Skip to main content](#)

Create



Google failing to honor their warranty.



dreadnought_strength • 5mo ago

Camera bezel came detached from my Pixel 9, and had less than 10' of Bluetooth range. Spent months attempting to get it fixed, and in that time the OLED failed randomly.

Eventually got the phone sent back, and Google claimed it had been dropped. I pointed out there was zero external damage and it had spent its life in a case, then they claimed it was actually water damage. I asked how water damage could remove my camera bezel and prevent the Bluetooth from working, and they changed the story again to drop damage - and wanted \$599 to replace the screen and refused to address any of the other issues unless I paid it.

I eventually used our ombudsman to intervene and force a refund, but I'll never buy a Google product again.



CaptainMarder • 5mo ago

Pixel 8,6,3,1, Nexus6p,5

That's insane. I wonder what parts are going to fall off a pixel 10 in a few months



SweatyAdagio4 OP • 5mo ago

Geez, that's an insane amount of hassle, can't believe they made you go through those lengths to resolve it. For me it's also the last time I'll buy a Google product.



[deleted] • 5mo ago



Gamefart101 • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

I had a the vertical line repaired (under extended warranty) on Sunday since it's a known issue. When I took the phone home It was fine. By yesterday morning (Monday) it had a new vertical line in a worse place than before and a black spot of dead pixels. But Google says I'm only eligible for one screen replacement.

They literally made my phone worse and called it fixed



SweatyAdagio4 OP • 5mo ago

Yikes! One of the posts I referenced also encountered a similar screen issue with the Pixel 9, so looks like they haven't properly addressed it yet even with newer models. Wonder if the Pixel 10 will reveal any similar issues over time. I'm sorry this happened to you. Are you going to try and resolve it somehow? Maybe through the retailer if you didn't buy it from Google?



[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)

again



lululock • 5mo ago

It's not a Google issue, but a Samsung panel issue... Multiple brands have the issue.



[1 more reply](#)



BlueMagic53 • 5mo ago

Check my post history, EXACTLY what happened to me as well, just a few weeks ago! Fucking fraud, that's what it is.

Edit: I'll also file complaint with local consumer protection in Austria.



SweatyAdagio4 [OP](#) • 5mo ago

I was surprised to see multiple people with the same problem on the Pixel 8 in the same week as me. Happy to hear you'll also file a complaint.



BlueMagic53 • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

Your post really motivated me to do it, thanks for that! Just collected all details I got and sent an initial email to Arbeiterkammer in Austria. Before, I kinda resigned already and wanted to just go through customer support of the shop I bought it from (which I'll do anyway in the meantime), lol.

Edit: Feel free to add my Post (which isn't as detailed as most others though) to your list, just to further prove your point. :-)



BlueMagic53 • 5mo ago

Update: Ha, as if they overheard, I just got the UPS package with my unrepaired phone delivered. Recorded the whole unboxing and made a 2 minute video of holding it into the camera from all angles. To me, there's absolutely no damage to be seen, except from 2-3 MINOR scratches on the edges which in no universe justifies their repair being rejected.



SweatyAdagio4 [OP](#) • 5mo ago

Exactly the same issue. I got my Pixel 8 back today from UPS, unrepaired, from the repair center in Poland. I filmed the unboxing in case they messed it up, packed it up again and sent it to the retailer instead. I called the retailer and sent them the videos so they have the evidence of the issue and of the phone. Mine has a minor scratch too near the usb-c port from using it for charging, not sure how to avoid that though. Other than that it looks

[Skip to main content](#)[+](#) Create**BlueMagic53** • 5mo ago

Yeah, I mean it happens, my phone's almost two years old - it's simply the normal "wear and tear" you'd expect after all this time, and I'd even argue that for 2 years of use, my phone looks way better than the average.
I'll do the exact same thing now and open a case with Digitec (it was bought in Zurich) and try to go through them. :-) I'll keep my fingers crossed for us!

**Selgald** • 5mo ago

Write gamersnexus an email with everything, they love that stuff and did a piece about Asus because they were scum too.

**ducklingboi** • 5mo ago

They can't even handle the 100usd refund for my pixel6a properly. Been 3 weeks and I only keep getting useless emails saying please wait for us resolve this issue, we definitely will. I've received this useless email at least 4 times already. Come on, i just want the refund because you cant fix this cheap ass battery you placed on your cheap ass device.

**bfix** • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

Seems like they didn't learn anything from the same issue with the Pixel 4A. [Here's my experience](#) with getting the appeasement for the 4A battery issue, opened case on January 8th, received money February 24th.

**Certified_GSD** • 5mo ago

Pixel 6 Pro | Mint Mobile

My 4XL had the bad battery issue where it wouldn't charge and wouldn't know how much charge it had in my first week of owning it.

iFix said Google wouldn't not warranty a repair and it needed to be sent to them. I was pretty pissed off and just used a OP6T for a few months.

When I finally did send it in using their materials to get fixed, Google claimed the screen and back glass was damaged and that they wouldn't fix it under warranty and sent it back. I was even more pissed because then it means they damaged it during transport.

It did come back to me and the glass was fine. Still had the battery issue though. Eventually I went out of state to another iFix and they ended up fixing it under the almost expired warranty.

**[deleted]** • 5mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)

horrible



[deleted] • 5mo ago



giovannixxx • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

I sent a Pixel 6 Pro in for replacement ages ago, and they sent me a IMEI banned Pro as a replacement. I had to fight them for a few weeks getting the run-around before I escalated the issue high enough for someone to do something.

I was without a new phone for weeks because of their shitty repairs center. Something similar happened with an old Nexus device I had to send in as well, I just assume they'll lose my items if I send anything else to Google.

Edit: [Old post](#), I was mistaken..... they sent me a scratched to shit replacement before the blacklisted one. Oops



Rebootkid • 5mo ago

Google doesn't want to do warranty services. They fight it tooth and nail.

I ran into with my 4a, and the battery issue. They claimed that the camera didn't work, and was thus exempt from replacing the battery (side note, the camera worked and still works fine)

With my 7a, the battery started swelling. Thankfully I'd bought the extended service contract with my provider when I got the phone, and when I pointed out the battery swell they said it was a Google problem. A bit of back and forth via tickets, Google finally agreed and swapped the battery.

Google wants you to just toss the device and buy something new. They're not as bad about it as other companies out there, but they do not want folks to repair devices.



aNamelessFox • 5mo ago

Ugh, I currently have the line and worry about sending the phone back cause I know people have so many horror stories with the repair service. Sigh. Sorry this happened to you (and so many other people).



benwayy • 5mo ago

This is likely not google directly, but the 3rd party they farm everything out to counting on the fact that people just give up. I'd wager the 3rd party also offers internal incentives to cases where they either find no need to repair, find a non covered repair, or both. I worked in consulting for many companies including several with consumer electronic divisions. That's exactly how these 3rd parties make money.



[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)

as well. I mostly talked to people whom I assumed were from the Philippines based on the accent. I know they're following the script, couldn't get mad at them, but I'm mad at Google for having such a horrible protocol. I wonder if "the higher-tier department" I escalated the issue too and shared the videos with were actual Google employees or not, but regardless, it doesn't matter, it's Google doing this and there's no way they're not aware of these problems by now. There's countless of posts dating back years.

**benwayy** • 5mo ago

yep agree. i highly doubt ANYONE at google will ever see this, unless you catch their attention here

**kmaniadee** • 5mo ago

I have the vertical line issue on my p8 and was just told yesterday by the 3rd party repair shop Google recommended that they won't fix it because of a microscopic scratch on the screen corner. They literally just come up with excuses to not fix things under warranty so they don't have to do work for free. Shits a scam

**ultradip** • 5mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Class action would be appropriate if there can be a pattern established.

**SweatyAdagio4** **OP** • 5mo ago

Yeah, not something I'm willing to get myself into to be honest. I'm happy this post is getting some traction. I hope the report I made to the ACM will do something, one other person did the same in Austria. Or European Small Claims court: https://europa.eu/youreurope/business/dealing-with-customers/solving-disputes/european-small-claims-procedure/index_en.htm

**bibober** • 5mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro

Class action

At least in the USA (which is where 'class action' is a thing as far as I'm aware), there is a binding arbitration agreement with Pixel devices. Unless you opted out, you cannot sue. Any other class members would have also needed to opt out. I can't imagine that even a fraction of 1% of owners actually opt-out within the allowed 30 day period.

[4 more replies](#)**Zeddie-** • 5mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)

About a few months later I had a different issue and Google wouldn't warranty it saying the IMEI didn't match the original purchase. Even though they had on record I had the motherboard replaced on the first warranty claim.

I paid for their extended warranty and I couldn't use it!

I needed an upgrade at the time anyways. They got me like Apple got their customers and I did buy the Pixel 6 Pro (big upgrade). At the time, I had to deal with the issue until it was released (the face unlock stopped working).



FlyByTi • 5mo ago

Been stung with the 'battery update' on 2 of my pixel phones, now reluctantly bought an iPhone. Just feels like planned obsolescence.



SweatyAdagio4 OP • 5mo ago

Smh, really unfortunate. Kind of defeats the whole 5-7 years of software updates if the phones struggle to reach 2 years in many cases and Google refuses to repair some



FlyByTi • 5mo ago

Agreed. It's a trust thing for me with their phones. Now I've moved to apple I can't see myself moving back.



Oris5 • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

I'm just about to send in my Pixel 8 for repairs because of the pink line issue (it's also going to Poland for repairs) this week. Now I'm quite worried about how it's gonna go, but don't think I have much of an option if I want it (maybe) repaired.



SweatyAdagio4 OP • 5mo ago

Send it in, you never know. I'm collecting these negative experiences but there are people who have had positive experiences. I really don't know what their criteria for scamming people is but even from the Poland center I've seen positive experiences.

1. Did you record footage and pictures of what your device looks like prior to sending? No cosmetic damage? Did you record evidence of the vertical line? If not, do it before you send it please! It might be the leverage you need. Delay sending in your device if you can't replicate the issue, because they denied the issue being there even after sharing footage. Ideally wait until the line is permanent (might already be the case for you, but just wanted to check)
2. Did you purchase it directly from Google or from a retailer? Since you're already about to send it to Google, I guess you might as well give it a shot. I sent mine to the retailer and hoping they will

[Skip to main content](#)

Create

[8 more replies](#)**unitedbsd** • 5mo ago

Worst service center of Google are in India. Real scams i have had so bad experience just for battery change I am never suggesting Google pixel to anyone in India

**ClacksInTheSky** • 5mo ago

Pixel Watch 2

I sent a Pixel 7 Pro in that had the infamous camera exploding glass issue.

Only I sent it about 12 months after it happened (when my partner had a new phone to use) and, surprisingly, they sent a refurbished Pixel 7 Pro back without hassle 🙌

**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

Don't get me wrong, I've seen people with good experiences too. Of course people are less likely to post about bad experiences. I found a decent number of people on tweakers (Dutch tech news and forum website) report fairly positive experiences, but there's an alarming number of bad experiences very similar to mine as I showed in the post. And to reiterate, this was me doing a quick search on reddit. There were similar posts on Google's own support forum.

**ClacksInTheSky** • 5mo ago

Pixel Watch 2

If it helps, Motorola tried to deny a return within 28 days of getting a Nexus 6P that has yellowing on the LCD, clearly a manufacturing defect (wasn't UV treated for long enough) because the device was rooted.

They argued their warranty didn't allow for rooted devices, I argued my statutory rights to return a faulty device within 28 days. I ended up threatening a Section 75 refund with my credit card issuer and then they folded and sent a new phone (I didn't want a refurb).

I rooted that and used it for a few years without problem but that was the last Motorola I bought.

Edit:

Also, yes, I believe your experience and I've seen a lot of stories of bad RMA with them. My Pixel 7 Pro went to Poland too (and the replacement came from Germany).

[2 more replies](#)**anthonyg45157** • 5mo ago

Yes this happened to me. Can dig up the post if needed but they absolutely claimed damage then had the audacity to ask me for photos before I sent.

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

One of the posts I mentioned actually managed to get a repair out of them and they shared the photo of the damaged speaker mesh. It's really tough to see if the mesh is even damaged in the photo as it's pretty dark and deep in the speaker hole.

**crispytaylor** • 5mo ago

My P9P had a green vertical line on it. Sent it in and received the phone repaired in 3 days. However the back glass was cracked upon return. Support told me to wait for a higher up to email me. Never heard from the higher up but received an email that an RMA had been created 5 business days later. A replacement phone is set to arrive today.

**CheetahAfraid9474** • 5mo ago

Also just got my p8 back from a panel switch, also in the EU and the pink vertical line. They reported a damaged front cam and frame issue. Had to pay 160€ . Was also using Case but since i changed the battery via ifixit package i thought i might have damaged some parts. Reading this here i really feel ripped Off.... Was considering changing to p10p but now Google wont get a dime from me in the Future. Was a Google Fan for years (4,5,7 and now p8) but this is messed Up.

**The_Superfluous** • 5mo ago

Squeaky wheel gets the grease, my friend. Keep going at it.

I had the horizontal line pop up on my Pixel 8 (bought Jan '23) a couple of months back, and went to uBreakiFix for the free repair. Thankfully, I was in and out of the shop in about 10-15 minutes with absolutely no hassle.

[9 more replies](#)**bfx** • 5mo ago

is it me or are these issues more common in Europe than the US? I read a lot of this stuff on Reddit from Europeans and also in German tech boards there's a lot of similar experiences. It seems that in the US the default option is to be sent to uBreakiFix which has (according to Wikipedia at least) more than 900 locations in the US for same day repair. That's strong contrast to having one repair center for multiple countries in Europe where even if everything goes alright you're a week without your phone. In Germany they seem to have partnered with Comspot who have 5 repair points in Germany, I might try to go this route if the vertical line becomes a permanent issue. It's still bad service in my opinion that the only option is to send it in without replacement in many cases. They could at least lend you a device for the time of the repair. It almost feels like they're trying to gauge how far they can go with European customer rights legislation.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**BigE Cheese45** • 5mo ago

I wanted to post my experience that just happened today. So about 3 months ago I got the vertical green line on my pixel 9 pro. Contacted AT&T my provider who deferred me to Google. After reaching out to Google they informed me my phone is under warranty and I could go to asurion (Ubreakifix) for the repair. I arrived at the repair shop and dropped the phone off.

After a few hours passed I received a phone call from the repair shop who informed me the phone was not covered under warranty and I would have to pay for a screen replacement. At that time, I informed the individual that I did not want the repair. After making the hour drive back to the repair store the technician brought my phone out (fixed) and proceeded to ring me up for the repair. I informed him I did not want the repair and I never gave him permission to continue doing it. Also, I pressed him on why it wasn't covered under warranty and he said "there is damage or something to the phone" I asked what damage there was that would void the warranty because there was no damage to the phone whatsoever and it is less than a year old. The repair tech continued stating things such as "it's a screen issue or something, I'm not sure but I fixed it".

I'm just more frustrated because this is such a known issue (the line) and Google refusing to fix it for free is frustrating. Needless to say I paid the fee to have the screen fixed because it was already installed though it was done so without my permission.

**NotThatPro** • 5mo ago

Hey shitass google execs, in the EU you can get huge fines for this type of shit and I hope you do get them because Apple of all companies beats the shit out of your "experience". You want to be the premium android everywhere in the world? Not just America? Invest in quality service and word of mouth will pay itself back. You can ask however much you want for a screen replacement but if it's a hardware defect (READ THE T&Cs WHEN I SETUP MY PIXEL) YOU HAVE TO HONOR THE 2 YEAR WARRANTY. If it's a bad screen and it has problems outside of normal wear and tear, it gets replaced, no questions asked! That's how you win Apple users, reducing friction ffs. Just great let's reduce the return/faulty repair rates on our internal metrics by screwing the ones who trusted us with our money. COOOOL

**BlueMagic53** • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

Hey folks! Got one more update. After Reddit Support reached out, we got a new response from Google now. They now claim the "Speaker Mesh" is broken which does not fall under warranty. Makes no sense, there is no damage to be seen and I've seen quite a few reports of people where they made the exact same claim although there is no damage to be seen at all. This is all as fraudulent as it can possibly be. Legal intervention is on the way though, Austrian Consumer Protection does see a clear case here, so PLEASE, whoever faces the same experience, file a claim with local authorities and let Google pay for their - pretty apparent - fraudulent Repair Center. They can only do it as long it's cheaper to fight a few resistant customers compared to the lions share of people who just give up.

@u/SweatyAdagio4 - Exact replica of your case it seems... Any news from Dutch authorities?



[Skip to main content](#)

Create



dropdown, they're not even trying to come up with a realistic excuse. Also, they're not even allowed to refuse repair due to an unrelated issue. Speaker mesh has no influence on the display issue, and as far as I know its illegal to refuse repair due to an unrelated cosmetic issue.

Anyway, unfortunately the Dutch consumer authorities have not yet responded to my report. I'll maybe try to contact them next week.

My phone is with the retailer at the moment, hoping they can repair it in the meantime, but regardless of my personal outcome I do want to continue to escalate this. Happy you're doing the same in Austria AT. Thanks again for the update.

**BlueMagic53** • 5mo ago

Apparently, yeah. LOL.

That's exactly what I was told by the lawyer. They must repair it by EU law despite any other (unrelated) issue and also they found it super interesting that Google stated "we either repair everything, or nothing".

Awesome! I'll keep you posted and would appreciate it, if you'd keep me posted as well. I am absolutely willing to fight for this, no matter what.

Thx for your reply as well and fingers crossed. :-)



2 more replies

**-Radiation** • 5mo ago

At this time buying a phone from Google in the age of information either one is masochist or naive

**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

I wouldn't after this experience. I also just browsed through some reviews back in 2023 when I bought it, and most reviews were pretty positive: Not the best at anything, but a good all rounder, and that sounded good to me. Of course the phone was brand new then so the reviews I watched were reviewing a phone with no screen damage and no experience with their RMA process.

**[deleted]** • 5mo ago

I gotta say, after reading your experience among many others, I'm really glad I got "lucky" and managed to purchase a Pixel 9 with *[at least so far; knock on wood]* no hardware issues or manufacturer defects.

I don't think I'll be buying another Google product based on all of this.

**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

I was surprised to find a post where the Pixel 9 also ended up having a vertical line issue with the display, one of the one's I listed. I don't see many though, it's mostly the Pixel 8, so I think (hope)

[Skip to main content](#)[+](#) Create**[deleted]** • 5mo ago

Indeed! I appreciate it.

I quite like my 9, and I also quite liked my 7 until it smashed [my fault]. I originally wanted the 7 for the size/form factor and a good camera for stills, and beyond that as long as the battery lasted until I got home [or ideally bedtime] and I had signal when I needed it, I could care less about specs/benchmarks/gaming etc.

Both the 7 and 9 did/do all I want with aplomb. The 9 basically does all the same shit but better aside from the camera, which seems more or less a lateral change.

All in all I'm happy with the device, and low-key kinda glad my 7 broke when it did, otherwise my contract wouldn't have been up until well after the 10s dropped and I might've ended up with a lemon.

**TheLightStalker** • 5mo ago

Exactly the same thing happened to me except I showed them the video of it being absolutely perfect and received a refund.

**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

Yeah, they're claiming they can see speaker mesh damage in my video and saying that means they won't repair it free of charge. I sent them two videos 1) with the vertical screen problem and 2) the phone before sending it in looking brand new. They only said that the footage shows speaker mesh damage, which as I've said in other comments, wasn't visible in the footage because you have to get really up close with a flash and focus in the speaker hole to get a clear picture of any such damage. Highly sus

**TheLightStalker** • 5mo ago

And when you take the free battery offer they say your screen needs to be replaced. (Because of a scratch) When in reality they broke the screen trying to take it off doing the battery swap.

**Mgannon1984** • 2mo ago

Google just did this to me, sent phone in for battery recall, the battery was expanding. They check it out and tell me it also has a sensor issue that's not covered by the recall and I must pay 119. I pay it because I want it fixed of course. When I received my phone back the receipt says they only replaced the battery and did a software update. I contacted support to ask for a refund since a sensor was never replaced and they tell me the software update is the actual fix for the sensor. I told them why would they charge me for a software update I could have performed myself. They are still fighting me on it waiting for the next

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#) [+ 1 more reply](#)**pol5xc** • 5mo ago

Thank god I contacted Amazon when my pixel 8's screen became green.

 [+ 2 more replies](#)**fatlardo** • 5mo ago

I don't know if this data helps. I did a trade in, brand new pixel 9pro xl that I got cheap with my carrier to trade in. It just sat there for a year till the new 10 pro came out. I did a trade in and have a video of it sending in in brand new condition. The trade in results say major LCD damage. I have a case opened.

**cap_dave** • 5mo ago

And worse you can no longer purchase preferred care for pixels in Canada...

 [+ 1 more reply](#)**Conscious-Ad-5062** • 5mo ago

I'm from Italy and I have the same pixel 8 display problem. I sent it to Poland and they told me that to repair the display problem they have to replace the frame, due to small scratches that I don't care about, and obviously I have to pay 129€. I'm trying to convince them to replace only the display but reading all this comment I think it's impossible...

**SweatyAdagio4** [OP](#) • 5mo ago

It's technically illegal in the EU to refuse defects due to unrelated cosmetic damage. They did the same to me though, they don't seem to care. Did you get your device directly from Google or a retailer? If you got it from a retailer, try to resolve it from them. There might be less hoops to jump through to actually get a replacement

**Conscious-Ad-5062** • 5mo ago

Yeah I know, in fact in the last email I wrote that for the EU law they are forced to repair the issue, despite problem and damage not related to the screen. I'm curious to see how they reply. I've got my device from an online store, but I sent it direct from Google for the warranty

 [+ 1 more reply](#)

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)

We got strong consumer protection here in EU and I'd love to keep it that way, so we gotta step up, every single report counts to raise awareness and put pressure on Google to get their shit together if they wanna continue to make business in EU.

**Conscious-Ad-5062** • 5mo ago

Yes if they still refuse to repair my phone I'm going to report the situation to the consumer protection authorities

**BlueMagic53** • 5mo ago

Love to hear that! Please keep me/us posted here, curious to hear the outcome for you all, as I am going through exactly the same right now. :-)

[+ 1 more reply](#)**Peek_a_Boo_Lounge** • 5mo ago

My recent RMA with the Polish repair center went fine.

My Pixel 9 Pro got a pink line a few weeks ago. Didn't want to send it in for repair since I don't have a back-up phone and didn't want to be without a phone for weeks. Did an RMA, Google sent me a new device and I sent my broken one to Poland. Once they got it, they let go of the hold on my credit card and everything was fine.

Same thing with my old Pixel 8. The volume button fell off and they sent me a new phone and they didn't give me any problems with the broken one.

[2 more replies](#)**[deleted]** • 4mo ago

Just to add to this, I sent a P8P (that had always been kept in a Spigen Tough Armour case with screen protector and only had cosmetic scratches to the outside) in for RMA due to performance issues, battery issues and loss of WiFi and Bluetooth connectivity. Had an email today stating phone had been inspected at their repair centre in Poland and they had discovered a "broken screen" as a further issue to what I'd already reported and want extra payment to repair this. Speaking to their extremely unhelpful support staff at the moment to try and get images of the claimed damage and see where I can go from here.

**SweatyAdagio4** **OP** • 4mo ago

Thanks for sharing, it's good to have more people chime in with their experience.

[Skip to main content](#)

Create

**Vegetable_Win5074** • 4mo ago

Exactly the same issue. Sent to repair shop (Poland), "outside frame or back cover damage" (non existent), shop wanted to fix it for additional 365 euro, no partial repair. This repair shop in Poland is a scam, that's all.

Support chat stands with repair shop so there is nothing to do.

Pixel was supposed to feel premium but I feel like trash consumer instead :) Google ships broken device, and when customers want a fix, Google imagines issues out of thin air just to decline the warranty.

Let's make sure to inform all we know that Pixels are not worth buying, that's the only thing that can make these corporations reflect on their actions.



1 more reply

**Jesporthemoonbear** • 3mo ago

Exactly the same situation for me. Green line defect, upcharge for some minor scratches on the phone. I cancelled the repair. Guess I have to live with the green line...

**Big_Feedback_8903** • 3mo ago

Same issue, another one to add to the list! Sent Pixel 8 in under warranty as it stopped turning on, they claimed 'speaker mesh damage' only when I pressed them to explain what the claimed 'damage to the sides and back' of the device was.

No evidence exactly as stated on other posts, refusing to provide evidence of any damage

They state they cannot do a partial repair exactly the same as others

They selectively ignore parts of my emails and it feels like I am speaking to an AI bot. Like others my device was sent to the well documented scam repair centre in Poland.

I can't believe this is happening. Can someone from Pixel Community reach out as I am not paying the £125 + VAT they are asking for!



1 more reply

**BulbasaurIsOP** • 5mo ago

I recently also made a Reddit post for an issue I had. Bluetooth died, they told me it would be repaired. It could not be repaired so I got a refurbished phone. Now that one came without speaker grills so I have to send it back again. The Reddit team of Google support is likely to write on the post and contact you asking for some information. They may fix it right away or ghost you after.

Skip to main content



Create



They had contacted me already about a week and a half ago through reddit when I made my post, but that didn't help at all. They said they'd escalate the problem further but even after that it took the higher department a 10 days to reply to my video evidence saying the speaker grill is damaged in my photo (I sent a video, not a photo, although that's just semantics). While my video was very clear, to see the speaker grill you have to really get close to the speaker hole, use a flash and make sure it focuses on the speaker grill, not something I had thought of recording when I sent it. Even now that I have my device back I couldn't locate any visible damage to the speaker grill. There was a user in one of the posts I mentioned who shared a photo of what a damaged speaker mesh looks like:

https://photos.google.com/share/AF1QipPmopha131IIFYERDrjKDh4jSdt0z-JLc7oql591MEeEeKXpB9TLI2-ADS_INavXQ/photo/AF1QipPDkKI3mQmJNULPhSVZfLA5xsuJunFMduS6Md_j?key=aGRHYXBSUXNTNXIxd1lyQUkwbUI1NjZnbkxmcWtR

I couldn't find such an issue on mine. But even then, they're not allowed to refuse repair of the screen due to something unrelated.

**TheIndulgents** • 5mo ago

Stop buying pixels people. Jesus.

How many issues and examples do we need at this point?

**BulbasaurIsOP** • 5mo ago

It seems that for me it's going in the same direction they'll ghost I guess. They just write on the posts to save face. Anyhow, after reading some horror stories here on Reddit I did record both unboxing the replacement phone and packing it again just in case

**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

Good luck. Some people report having success with disputing such issues, but many don't as you can see. [u/PixelCommunity](#) might reach out, as they did with me, but that never solved the problem for me. Hope it works out for you

**BulbasaurIsOP** • 5mo ago

Also, leaving here a link to my post. Support would be appreciated!

<https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/s/qjVnftCfRL>

**SweatyAdagio4** OP • 5mo ago

I already added your post to the list. Hope you can get it resolved too. But yeah, [u/PixelCommunity](#) reaching out might not help. I remember reading one post last week where

[Skip to main content](#)

Create

**BulbasaurIsOP** • 5mo ago

Yeah they did reach out last Saturday and asked for some case info. And told them the whole situation, going from repair to replace with a refurbished and this being defective. I wrote to them again yesterday and they said they would escalate and come to me during the day, they never did.

**Sosbanfawr** • 5mo ago

Pixel 6

I did a Google trade in for my daughter and the third party claimed her phone didn't switch on. I had to threaten legal action and in the end I sent back the Pixel 9 and they returned the perfectly working Pixel 6 Pro, which had been set up(!) and gave me a £40 credit voucher. I really don't want to do it but I have tried again with the Pixel 10 256GB as the trade in is insane at the moment and no other brand new "high end" phone would be available to me for £348 plus my Pixel 8.

**lululock** • 5mo ago

To add a positive note :

Had a USB port issue on my P8P. Sent it. Got an email saying they won't have parts for a few weeks, proposed an exchange for a refurbished unit, keeping what was left of the warranty on the previous device. Got the replacement less than a week after sending it in. The refurbished unit looks brand new, untouched.

They even messed up and extended the warranty by 2 years, making it end in 2029. I won't complain lol.

[3 more replies](#)**Mysterious-Hat-5662** • 5mo ago

Upload the photos?

**SweatyAdagio4** **OP** • 5mo ago

Here you go: <https://imgur.com/a/gTFoJ0y>

All are screenshots of videos I took. One where I managed to capture the actual issue and showed the IMEI number on screen, the other after screen protector, case and usb-c plug were removed and ready for sending.

[3 more replies](#)



Create

